

Tony Cardone

Lead Architect / Engineering Manager

210-880-4316 | tcardone@outlook.com | [linkedin.com/in/tonycardone](https://www.linkedin.com/in/tonycardone) | tonycardone.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Architect and Engineering Leader with 12+ years designing and evolving distributed cloud platforms and guiding engineering teams across the US, Europe, and South America. Expertise in system architecture, AWS, Java, microservices, data platforms, and monolith-to-microservices modernization. Proven track record of defining technical strategy, driving organization-wide architectural decisions, and partnering with product owners, solutions implementation teams, engineering leaders, and executives to translate business priorities into scalable, reliable technology solutions from concept through production.

EXPERIENCE

Zilliant Incorporated | Austin, TX | June 2015 – November 2025

Zilliant is a B2B software company providing cloud-based pricing, revenue optimization, and sales solutions for large enterprise customers.

Engineering Manager (2025)

- Led two distributed Eastern European engineering teams totaling 15 developers and QA professionals, owning technical execution, delivery strategy, operational performance, and cross-team coordination.
- Retained company-wide architecture ownership while serving as Engineering Manager, establishing system-design standards and guiding high-impact architectural and technology tradeoffs across engineering teams.

Lead Architect / Architecture Manager (2021 – 2025)

- Led a seven-member architecture organization responsible for solution and platform architecture across Zilliant's product portfolio, including distributed APIs, cloud services, data platforms, and a large legacy monolith; reported directly to the CTO or VP of Engineering.
- Managed and mentored architects and engineers while partnering with engineering managers to develop technical talent, transfer architectural knowledge, and expand architecture practices across the organization.
- Owned end-to-end architecture for a new product offering, defining its system design and integration into the existing platform from initial requirements through production deployment.
- Partnered with product leadership during roadmap development to evaluate technical feasibility, expose architectural risks, and define tradeoffs that balanced product priorities, engineering cost, scalability, and delivery speed.
- Defined and drove the platform data strategy that established Amazon Aurora PostgreSQL as the primary transactional database, replacing customer-specific SQL Server deployments with a more scalable, lower-maintenance, and cost-efficient architecture and the pathway for the transition.
- Led the architectural transition from a Java monolith toward Dropwizard-based microservices, incrementally extracting platform capabilities into independently scalable services supporting hundreds of requests per second per datacenter.
- Established worker-based service patterns for long-running workloads, using AWS Batch and autoscaling to balance workload availability, scalability, and infrastructure cost, and the work needed to translate existing components to this model.
- Led architecture-level incident reviews and escalations for complex backend failures, identifying systemic design issues and guiding corrective solutions across engineering teams.
- Partnered with customer solutions teams to review implementation architectures, identify systemic design and performance risks, and define scalable approaches consistent with the broader platform architecture.

Senior Technical Lead (2015 – 2021)

- Led a ten-person hybrid US-Ukraine team delivering critical backend features for the platform using AWS and Salesforce offerings.
- Transformed the team's release model from quarterly deployments to daily delivery by redesigning engineering practices across requirements, architecture, development, testing, and release management.
- Improved synchronization between Salesforce SObjects and the AWS backend, increasing sync reliability, accelerating troubleshooting, and stabilizing environment staging.
- Integrated AWS Redshift into platform stack, offering a cost-efficient alternative to using SQL Server Enterprise for analytics, with support for variable workloads.
- Deployed AWS EMR solution as part of platform offering, allowing optional use of big data-style inbound data verification and cleanup operations as a standardized model. Clusters were created and destroyed through CloudFormation calls as part of their lifecycle for cost efficiency, resulting in zero standby cluster costs.
- Designed and led Custom Job Workflows with architecture team, uncoupling customer logic from static jobs and achieving near-100% adoption across existing projects while preserving backward compatibility. Supported evolution of unique customer needs within a consistent platform.

BNSF Railway Company | Fort Worth, TX | June 2013 – June 2015

BNSF is one of North America's largest freight railroads, operating a nationwide transportation network supporting industrial and commercial supply chains.

Systems Developer

- Developed Java-based predictive analytics systems with mechanical engineering experts to identify rolling-stock risks, reduce derailments, and improve fleet reliability.
- Delivered Java applications and predictive analytics data to BNSF's Network Operations Center for continuous 24/7/365 operational evaluation, using IBM DB2 and WebSphere.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Architecture & Platforms: Distributed Systems, Microservices, REST APIs, Event/Worker Architectures, Multitenancy, Platform Modernization, Cloud Architecture

Cloud: AWS, ECS, EC2, Lambda, Batch, Aurora PostgreSQL, EMR, CloudFormation

Languages: Java, Python, SQL, R, Salesforce Apex

Data & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Redshift, Docker, ELK Stack

Engineering: CI/CD, Git, Observability, Production Operations, System Design, OpenAI Codex, OpenCode. Architecture Reviews

EDUCATION

Master of Science – Data Science | 2026

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX
Rawls College of Business

Bachelor of Science – Computer Science | 2013

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX | Minor: Mathematics
Whitacre College of Engineering